Alumnyx – Bridging the Gap Between Students and Alumni Networks

A PROJECT REPORT

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in partial fulfillment for the award of the degree

of

BACHELOR OF ENGINEERING

in

COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING

Dr. N.G.P INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, COIMBATORE - 641048

AN AUTONOMOUS INSTITUTION

ANNA UNIVERSITY: CHENNAI 600 025

MAY 2026

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DECLARATION

I hereby declare that the project work entitled "**Alumnyx – Bridging the Gap Between Students and Alumni Networks**" submitted to the autonomous 22UCS407-Idea & Design sprint viva voce – April 2025 is the report of the original project work done by me under the guidance of **Ms.R.Janagi M.E. Assistant Professor**, Department of Computer Science and Engineering, Dr. N. G. P. Institute of Technology, Coimbatore- 641 048.

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

Words act as a gateway to express tokens of acknowledgement. First of all, we would like to thank the supreme power, our **Parents** and **Almighty God**, who has given us the strength and courage to complete our work successfully.

would like to express our profound gratitude and deep sense of thanks to **Dr. Nalla G. Palaniswami MD., AB (USA)**, Chairman of Kovai Medical Center and Hospital, for providing us with the necessary facilities to complete our project work effectively.

Our heartfelt gratitude to **Dr. Thavamani D Palaniswami MD., AB (USA)**, Secretary of Dr. N. G. P. Institute of Technology, for her generous attitude and motivation, which had been one of the reasons to complete our project.

We are sincerely grateful to **Dr. S. U. Prabha M.E, Ph.D.** Principal who has always been a source of inspiration, well-wisher and a pillar of support for all the students in our institution by rendering full motivation always.

We are sincerely thankful to **Dr. D. Palanikkumar M.E, Ph.D.** Professor and Dean of Computing Sciences, for his continuous support, valuable guidance, and encouragement during our project work.

We are highly indebted to **Dr.V.Praveena M.E, Ph.D.** Professor and Head of Computer Science and Engineering Department, for her dedication, interest and overwhelming attitude to help students that have helped us to a great extent to accomplish this task.

We wish to thank our Idea & Design Sprint Coordinator **Dr.J.Poongodi, M.E, Ph.D,** Assistant Professor(SS) Department of Computer Science and Engineering, for her excellent assistance, aspiring guidance, regular feedback and invaluably constructive ideas.

We express our heartfelt thanks to our Project Guide Ms. **R. Janagi M.E,** Assistant professor, Department of Computer Science and Engineering, for her valuable guidance and timely help for completing our project.

Finally, we owe huge thanks to our teaching **Faculty members** and **Non-teaching** staff members, whose love and insights have enriched our work.

ABSTRACT

This project involves the work carried out in developing a platform for college alumni's networking, a smart and easy-to-use system to enhance the relation between students and alumni of a single institution. In many colleges, students often do not have direct access to alumni for guidance, career advice, and opportunities in the real world, while alumni do not have many ways to give back or stay involved with their college community.

The platform solves this issue by offering a centralized web-based system for students, graduates, and administrators to interact without any issues. Alumni can provide knowledge of job opportunities, internships and industry information, while students can seek mentorship, guidance, and support for career development. The system also has role-based access control to the system where super admins control the overall functioning of the platform, department admins control department-specific users, and only verified alumni can contribute to ensure trust and authenticity of the information.

To increase the credibility, features such as profile verification, portfolio uploads and a review-based trust system are built into the platform. These elements help to create a reliable and transparent network in which users can trust connecting and collaborating. The interface is designed to be simple and intuitive, making it easy for users to navigate and engage without any complexity.

Beyond networking, this platform is a supportive ecosystem that fosters knowledge sharing, professional development and long-term engagement between students and alumni. It turns the traditional alumni connection into an active, accessible and meaningful experience. Overall, the project beyond solving the problem of disconnected alumni networks also has the added benefit of improving career and building a stronger institutional community.

Keyword :- Alumni Networking, Mentorship, Career Guidance, Job Portal, Internship Opportunities. Role-Based Access Control, User Verification, Trust System, Web Platform, Community Engagement

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LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS

ACRONYMS	ABBREVIATIONS
RBAC	Role-Based Access Control
API	Application Programming Interface
UI	User Interface
JWT	JSON Web Token
SQL	Structure Query Language
DB	Database
REST	Representational State Transfer
UAT	User Acceptance Testing
AI	Artificial Intelligence
IT	Information Technology

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CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

In today's digital world, it is important to keep a strong connection between alumni and their institution to share knowledge and grow their careers. However, many colleges lack an effective system to connect their alumni and students, which means missed opportunities in mentorship, networking and job guidance. This project launches an Alumni Networking Platform that serves as a centralized space for students, alumni, and administrators to interact. It allows users to establish profiles, share opportunities and effectively communicate within a secure and organised system. The platform is designed to enhance alumni engagement, support student development and help create a connected academic community that benefits both individuals and the institution.

1.1 NEED OF THE PROJECT

In many educational institutions after the students graduate, the link between the students and the college begins to dissolve. There is often no structured system to maintain contact with the alumni or to encourage contact with current students. As a result, valuable opportunities like mentorship, career guidance and internships and job referrals are often missed. Alumni have real-world experience, knowledge of industry and professional connections that can be very helpful to students but without a proper platform, this knowledge is underutilized.

Additionally, traditional ways of communication like emails or social media groups, are inefficient means of managing large alumni networks. These methods are not organized, lack verification, and do not have specific features for professional interaction. There is also a lack of trust and

authenticity in many open platforms, with user information not always being verified. Therefore, there is a great need for a specific system which can take care of secure registration, verified profiles, and organized communication.

This project is tackling these issues as it develops a centralised alumni networking platform to connect students, alumni and administrators. It guarantees constant involvement, creates a strong community within the institution and provides a good environment to share opportunities and knowledge.

1.2 OBJECTIVE

The main goal of this project is to design and develop a network platform for alumni which is efficient and easy to use; and to support the interaction between students and alumni and institutional administrators. The idea behind the system is to provide a digital space where users can create professional profiles, share accomplishments and connect with others, depending on their department or interests.

Another important goal is to offer career-oriented features like job postings, internship opportunities and mentorship programs. Alumni can mentor students by sharing their experiences, and students can ask for advice and explore career paths. The platform also wants to incorporate its event management capabilities and enable institutions to conduct their reunions, webinars and networking events.

Security and access control are other objectives of the system. The platform will implement role-based access control where different users such as super admin, admin, students and alumni have specific permissions This ensures that data is managed properly and prevents unauthorized access to the data. Overall, the goal is to create a scalable and reliable system to improve collaboration, communication, and professional development.

1.3 SCOPE OF THE SYSTEM

The scope of this system involves the development of a web-based application as a centralized location of alumni and alumni-student interaction. The system will be able to register and to login using the role of the users i.e., student or alumni or admin. Alumni users will be able to create detailed profiles that include their educational background, work experience, and accomplishments, which can be used as a source of inspiration and guidance for students.

Students will be able to access features like searching for alumni and viewing their profile and connecting with them for mentorship or career advice. The system will also have functionalities for posting and viewing job opportunities, which will help the alumni to contribute to the placements of students. Administrators will control the verification of users, registration of alumni, and the general functionality of the platform.

The system is designed to be scalable, which means that additional features can be added in the future. These may include mobile application support, advanced analytics for tracking user engagement, integration with external job portals and AI-based recommendation systems. However, the present scope is restricted to fundamental functionalities including networking, communication and management .

1.4 SUMMARY

In conclusion, this project is aimed to create a structured and efficient solution to build a better relationship between alumni and current students. By solving the disadvantages of current communication methods, the system offers a dedicated platform that facilitates professional networking, mentorship, and knowledge sharing. It ensures that alumni would be connected to their institution and help them contribute actively towards the

growth of students.

The importance of the building of a strong academic community where experience and opportunity are shared effectively is highlighted in the project. Through features such as secure access, role-based management, and career support tools, the platform makes a meaningful and long-lasting impact. Overall, the system is not only beneficial for students and alumni, but also helps build the reputation of the institution and increases the engagement at a wider level. .

CHAPTER 2

LITERATURE SURVEY

2.1 INTRODUCTION

The literature survey plays a vital role in understanding the development of alumni networking systems and their impact on educational institutions. It provides insights into existing technologies, methodologies, and frameworks used to manage alumni data and engagement. By analyzing previous research and systems, it becomes possible to identify key challenges and areas for improvement.

Alumni networks contribute significantly to institutional growth by supporting mentorship, career opportunities, funding, and knowledge sharing. Studies highlight that strong alumni relationships enhance institutional reputation and student outcomes [10], [11]. However, the effectiveness of these contributions depends on how well institutions manage and engage their alumni.

Recent research also emphasizes the importance of digital platforms and data-driven approaches in improving alumni interaction and engagement [12], [15]. Therefore, there is a growing need for a structured, scalable, and secure alumni management system.

2.2 EXISTING SYSTEM

In the current scenario, most institutions use a combination of traditional and digital methods to manage alumni interactions. Common approaches include maintaining alumni records in spreadsheets or databases, communicating through emails, and creating social media groups on platforms like LinkedIn, WhatsApp, and Facebook. While these methods enable basic communication, they are not suitable for organized alumni networking.

Some institutions have developed dedicated alumni portals where users can register, update their profiles, and access announcements. These systems provide features such as event notifications, newsletters, and basic search functionality. However, research indicates that many of these platforms mainly focus on storing alumni data rather than enabling active engagement [13], [14].

Additionally, existing systems lack advanced functionalities such as real-time communication, job and internship portals, mentorship matching, and department-based management [8], [15]. Social media platforms are widely used for engagement, but they do not offer structured data management or proper control over user information [17]. Furthermore, many systems do not utilize modern technologies like analytics or network analysis, which can enhance alumni interaction and institutional decision-making [12]

2.3 LIMITIONS OF EXISTING SYSTEM

Despite providing basic functionality, existing systems have several limitations. One major issue is the lack of a centralized platform, as alumni information is often scattered across multiple channels such as emails and social media, making it difficult to manage and access efficiently [14].

Another limitation is the absence of proper verification and security mechanisms. Without a structured authentication process, it is difficult to ensure that only genuine alumni are registered, which affects trust and reliability. Many systems also lack role-based access control, making it difficult for administrators to manage users effectively.

Current systems also miss important features such as job and internship postings, mentorship programs, and event management tools, which limits the practical benefits for both students and alumni [15]. In addition, poor user interface design and low interactivity reduce user engagement [17]. The lack of scalability further restricts the ability to upgrade or expand these systems in

the future.

2.4 PROPOSED SYSTEM

The proposed system aims to overcome the limitations of existing systems by developing a centralized and efficient alumni networking platform. It is designed as a web-based application that enables seamless communication between students, alumni, and administrators.

The system includes secure registration and authentication mechanisms to ensure user authenticity and data security. A key feature is role-based access control, where different users such as super admin, admin, alumni, and students have specific permissions, improving system management and reliability.

The platform offers advanced features including job and internship postings, mentorship opportunities, profile management, event organization, and real-time communication. Research suggests that integrating these features significantly improves alumni engagement and collaboration [15], [18].

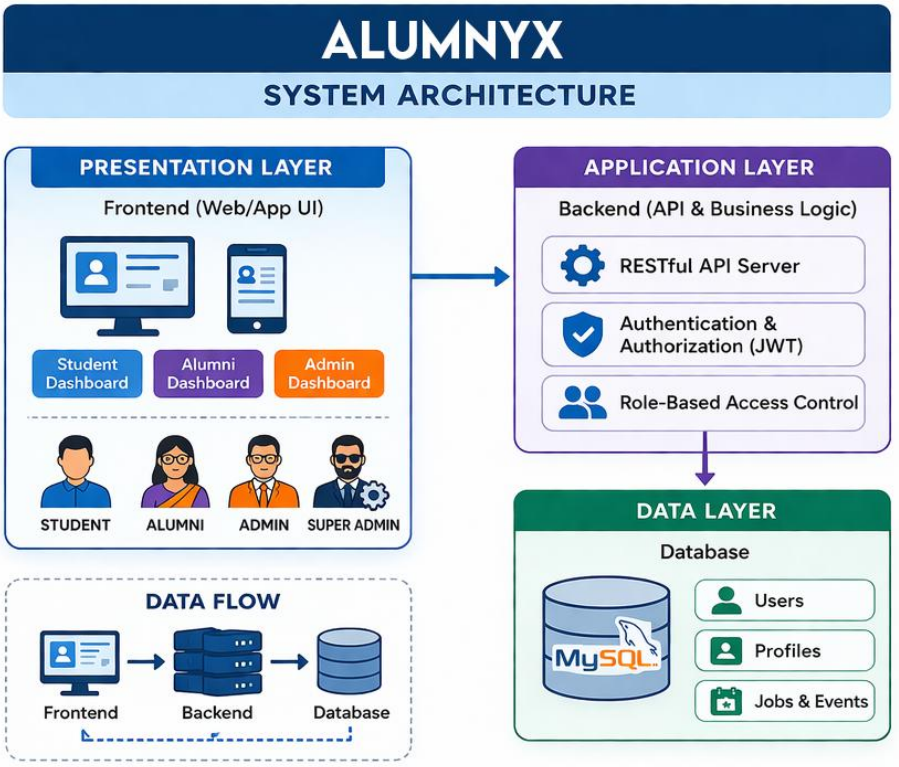
The system is also designed to be scalable and flexible, allowing future enhancements such as analytics, artificial intelligence, and social network-based recommendations [12], [19]. Overall, the proposed system provides a structured, secure, and user-friendly solution that strengthens alumni connections and supports student career development.

CHAPTER 3

SYSTEM OVERVIEW

3.1 SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

The architecture of the Alumni Networking Platform is based on a layered architecture to enable scalability, security, and maintainability. The architecture is divided into three layers, namely the presentation layer or frontend, the application layer or backend, and the data layer or database. The frontend is responsible for user interaction and provides a user interface for users, including students and alumni, to interact with the system. The backend is responsible for handling all user interactions and provides user authentication and access control to different users, including super admin, admin, alumni, and students. The database is responsible for storing all user information and data in a structured manner.

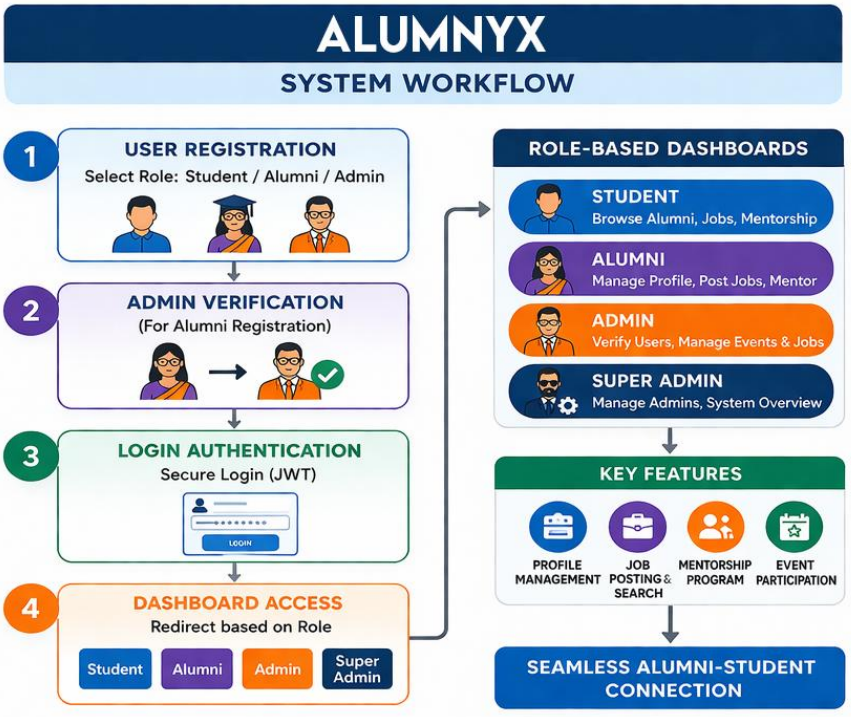


3.1 System Architecture

The architecture is based on multiple user roles, including super admin, admin, alumni, and students. Each user role has different permissions to enable access control to different functionalities. The architecture is based on user authentication and validation to enable security for handling user data. The architecture is based on a structured approach to enable efficiency, reliability, and maintainability in the near future.

3.2 SYSTEM WORKFLOW

The workflow of the system explains how users will interact with the system as well as how various processes will be executed. Initially, users will register in the system by identifying their roles, such as students or alumni. The alumni registration might need approval from the admin to guarantee authenticity. After registering in the system, users will log in to access various services according to their roles.



3.2 Workflow

For instance, students will be able to search alumni profiles and seek mentorship. Similarly, alumni will be able to edit their profiles as well as share job opportunities. On the other hand, the role of an administrator is to verify users, manage departments, as well as maintain the operations of the system. The super admin will have full control over the system, such as adding admins. The workflow of the system facilitates effective communication among users as well as smooth flow of information within the system. This will enable users to effectively utilize the system.

3.3 TECHNOLOGY STACK

The technology stack refers to the various tools and technologies used in developing the application. The front end is created by using modern front-end frameworks such as React or React Native to provide an interactive interface. Similarly, the back end is created by using modern back-end frameworks such as Node.js or other server-side frameworks. A relational database is used to store the application's data in an efficient manner by using MySQL.

For providing an efficient authentication mechanism in the application, JWT is used. In addition to this, APIs can also be used in the application. Similarly, Git is used as a version control tool in the application. Using these tools in developing the application ensures that it is efficient and can be used in real-world applications.

CHAPTER 4

MODULE DESCRIPTION

4.1 USER REGISTRATION & AUTHENTICATION

The User Registration and Authentication module acts as the entry point for the system. In this module, users can be registered based on their roles, whether students, alumni, or admins. They can be registered by providing relevant information like their name, email, department, and password. In the case of alumni, there is an additional step where the admin has to approve the registration to ensure authenticity.

In this module, secure authentication techniques like encrypted passwords and token-based authentication are used. This helps to secure user sessions and prevent any kind of unauthorized access. Other features like login validation, password reset, etc., are also included.

4.2 ROLE-BASED ACCESS CONTROL

The Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) module is responsible for defining and managing permissions for different classes of users within the system. Users are classified based on their role in the system, such as students, alumni, admin, and super admin. Users can only access features within the system based on their role. This ensures that users cannot misuse the features within the system and can only perform actions related to their role.

For example, a student role can view alumni profiles and apply for jobs, while an alumni role can edit profiles and post opportunities. Similarly, an admin role can verify users and manage content, while a super admin role can perform all admin functions.

4.3 ALUMIN MANAGEMENT MODULE

The purpose of the Alumni Management module is to cater to all aspects of alumni within the system. For alumni users, there is an option to create detailed profiles that include academic history, work experience, skills, and achievements. This helps students gain knowledge and guidance.

Admins are important for this module because they verify alumni registrations and ensure that only genuine users are part of this system. This module is useful for alumni contributions such as posting jobs, participating in mentorship activities, and engaging in events. This helps to keep all aspects of alumni organized and ensures reliability within the system.

4.4 STUDENT INTRACTION MODULE

The Student Interaction module is designed to facilitate effective communication between students and alumni. Students can search for alumni based on specific criteria, including the department, company, or job role, among others.

The Student Interaction module enables the sharing of knowledge, which is essential for the students as it helps them gain insight from real-life experiences about career development. The module also enables students to network with other professionals, which can come in handy for the students in the future.

The interaction between the students and alumni is structured, ensuring that the communication is purposeful and effective for the students involved.

4.5 JOBS & INTERNSHPIS PORTAL

The Job and Internship Portal is one of the most significant modules of the system, focusing on the employability of the students. The alumni and admin can add job opportunities, internships, and other relevant opportunities. The information added may include the job role, company name, eligibility, and deadline for the application, etc.

The students can view the opportunities, filter them based on their preferences, and apply for the opportunities. The module establishes a direct link between the alumni working in the industry and the students seeking opportunities.

4.6 COMMUNICATION SYSTEM

Communication System: The Communication System facilitates communication among users through messages, notifications, and announcements. This system allows students and alumni to communicate directly for mentorship and guidance. The admins can use notifications to send messages on events, jobs, and other announcements.

This module organizes and centralizes communication so that there is no confusion about different external systems for communication. This helps in better user engagement and keeps all users informed and connected within the system.

CHAPTER 5

SYSTEM IMPLEMENTATION

5.1 FRONTEND DEVELOPMENT

The frontend of the system is created using modern technologies such as React, which is known to provide an effective responsive interface. The frontend of the application contains separate dashboards for students, alumni, and admins, each of them created according to their functionality.

The frontend of the application is concerned with providing an effective user interface to the application. The application contains various components such as forms, profiles, jobs, and dashboards created in an effective way to provide an interactive interface to the application.

5.2 BACKEND DEVELOPMENT

The backend has the responsibility of overseeing all the core functionalities of the application. This includes data processing, authentication, and other business logic. This is done using technologies like Node.js, which helps in the efficient execution of server-side operations.

The backend has the role of overseeing the user data, the requests made by the frontend, and the database. In addition, the backend also oversees the inclusion of security mechanisms like encryption and authentication. This helps in the smooth running of the application under different user interactions

5.3 API INTEGRATION

API integration essentially acts as a bridge for communication between the frontend and backend. RESTful API is used for handling various requests such as user registration, login, updating user profiles, posting jobs, and retrieving information, among others.

APIs facilitate smooth communication and data transfer among various components of the system. API integration also enables real-time updates and increases the scalability of the system. Proper API integration enables smooth communication, thus increasing efficiency and speeding up responses.

5.4 TESTING & VALIDATION

Testing and validation are essential to ensure that the system functions correctly and meets user requirements. Various testing methods are used, including unit testing to check individual components, integration testing to verify interactions between modules, and user acceptance testing to ensure usability.

Errors and bugs are identified and fixed during this phase, improving system reliability. Validation ensures that all features work as intended and that the system is ready for deployment in a real-world environment.

CHAPTER 6

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

This chapter explains the step-by-step implementation of the system, covering development, integration, testing, and deployment. The collected results are analyzed, and a deep description of how the outcome was obtained is discussed.

6.1 OUTPUT SCREEN

The output screens show the final look of the interface of the system and how users can interact with the different modules of the program. The system has several screens for different users, like students, alumni, admins, and super admins.

The registration and login screens are provided with role selection and validation. The dashboard screens are different according to the roles of the users, like students can see the profiles of the alumni and job opportunities, the alumni can manage their own profiles and add job opportunities, and the admins can monitor and control the activities of the system.

The alumni profiles screen contains all the details of the alumni, like their educational background, experience, skills, and achievements, which helps the students understand the different career paths. The job portal screen helps users apply for the job or internship opportunities. In addition, the communication screens are also provided.

The output screens are user-friendly and easy to navigate, ensuring a user-friendly experience with the different functionalities of the program.

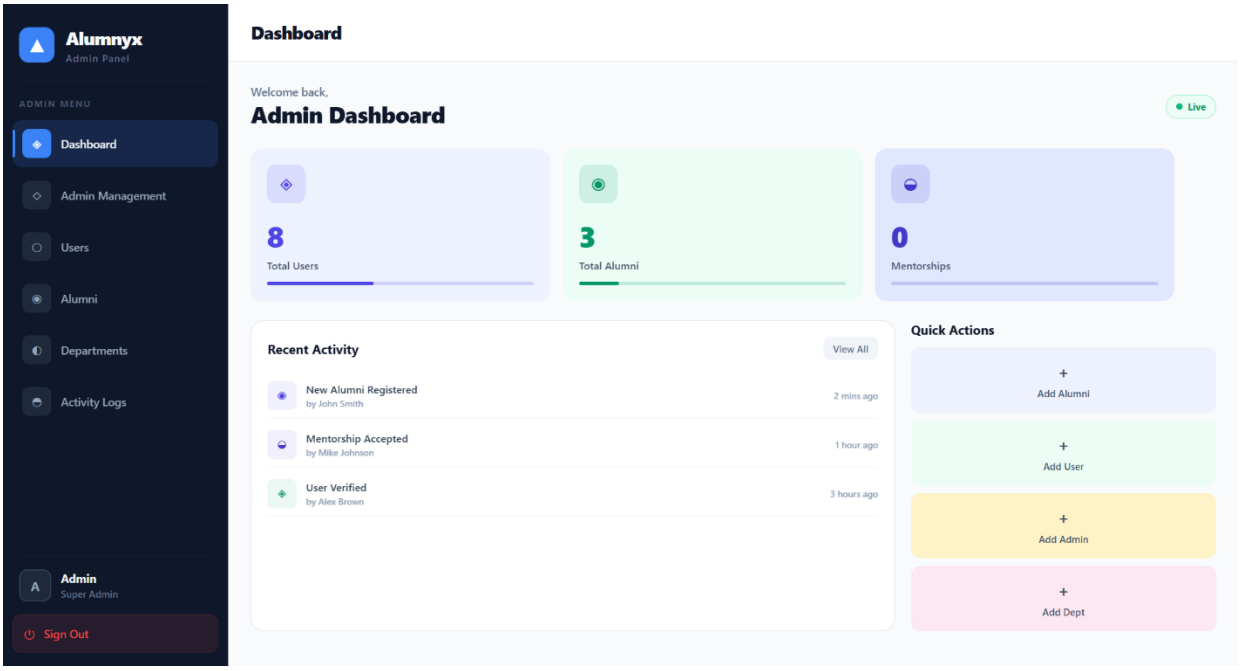


Fig 6.1 Admin Pannel

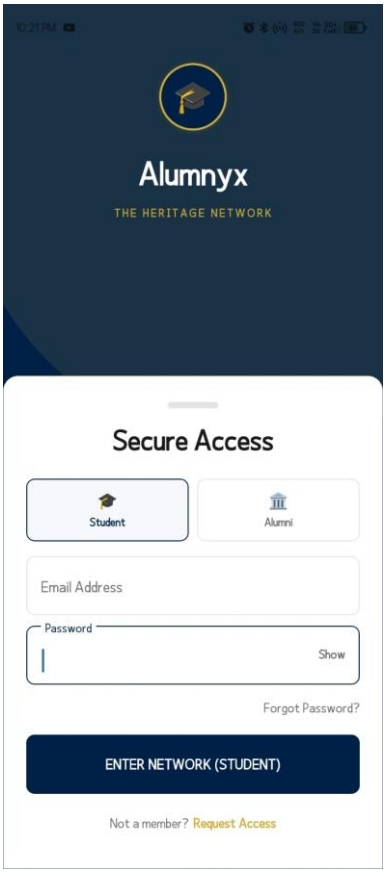


Fig 6.2 Login Page

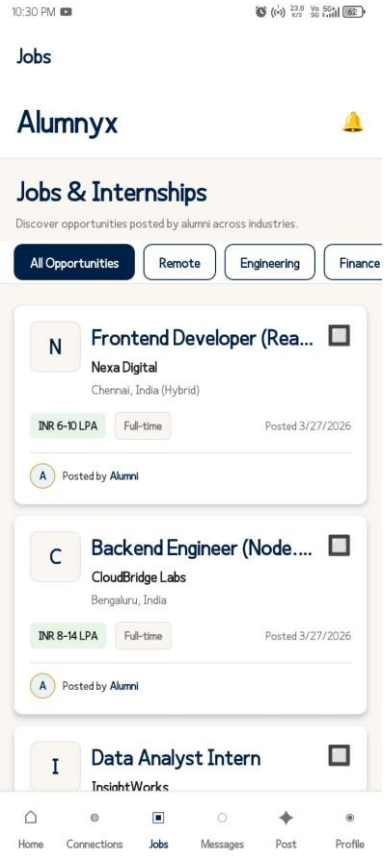


Fig 6.3 Jobs & Internship page

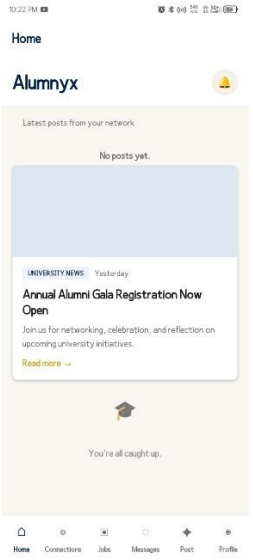


Fig 6.4 Home Page

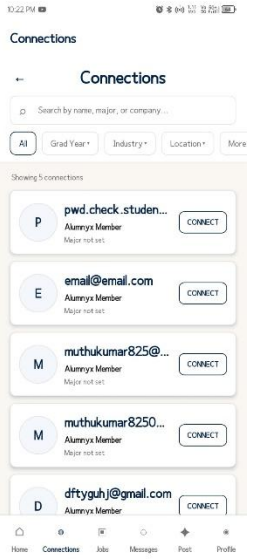


Fig 6.5 Connection Page

6.2PERFORMANCE ANALYSIS

The performance of the system can be assessed based on parameters like response time, scalability, reliability, and usability. The system can support multiple users simultaneously without causing any delay in interaction with other modules of the system.

The response time for activities like logging in to the system, viewing the user's profile, and searching for jobs is also optimized. This is done by effectively managing the API and database query execution. The usage of structured storage also helps in faster retrieval of data and quick response time.

The scalability of the system can be assessed based on parameters like the ability to support more users and data without compromising system performance. The system can support more users and can be extended to include new features without compromising existing features.

The reliability of the system can be ensured by using appropriate error handling techniques and authentication and validation techniques. The system can

be debugged to ensure its stability.

6.3 ADVANTAGES OF SYSTEM

The proposed system has some advantages compared to the traditional ways of managing alumni. One of the advantages is that the system provides a centralized platform for interaction and communication. This means that there will be no need for multiple communication channels.

The system provides secure and verified access to the users. This is done by using authentication and approval by the admin. This will ensure that the users can trust the system. The implementation of role-based access control in the system will ensure that different types of users can be managed effectively.

The system will also be useful for career development. This is due to the fact that the system provides direct access to job and internship opportunities. This means that the students will be able to learn from the interaction and communication features. The system is also flexible and scalable. This means that it can be enhanced in the future to include features such as mobile applications and AI. The system will be useful for improving engagement and communication within the academic community.

CHAPTER 7

CONCLUSION AND FUTURE WORK

7.1 CONCLUSION

The Alumni Networking Platform overcomes the shortcomings of existing systems by developing a well-structured, secure, and efficient system. This platform provides a centralized environment where students, alumni, and administrators can interact and share knowledge.

The inclusion of user authentication, role-based access control, alumni management, job portal, and communication system helps the system work efficiently. This system not only helps the university but also helps students develop by providing them with mentorship and career opportunities.

The system, by using advanced technologies and a user-friendly interface, proves to be a viable system for educational institutions. This system helps build relationships within the institution and provides a network that can be used by all.

7.2 FUTURE WORK

The system can be improved further by adding a mobile app, which will enable users to access the system at any time and from anywhere.

Advanced features like artificial intelligence-based job recommendations can be incorporated to provide users with relevant job opportunities according to their profiles and interests. Similarly, the system can be improved by adding artificial intelligence-based mentorship matching to help users find the right alumni mentors more effectively.

Data analytics can also be incorporated to enable the administrator to track the activities of users, engagement, and the overall performance of the system. The system can also be improved by integrating other platforms like LinkedIn or other job portals to enable users to access a wider range of job opportunities.

The system can be improved further by adding more advanced features like improving the security of the system, adding chat functionality, and improving the UI/UX of the system, which will enable the system to become more intelligent, efficient, and flexible to meet the requirements of users

APPENDIX

USER MANUL

Introduction

Alumnyx is a cross-platform alumni networking application designed to connect students and alumni. It enables users to build professional connections, explore job opportunities, communicate in real time, and showcase achievements.

User Types

The system supports the following users:

- **Students** – Can register and access the platform immediately
- **Alumni** – Require admin approval before accessing the platform

System Access

Registration

1. Open the application
2. Enter required details (name, email, password, department, etc.)
3. Submit registration
    - Students: Can log in immediately
    - Alumni: Must wait for approval

Login

1. Enter registered email and password
2. Click login
3. Access dashboard/home screen

Main Features

Home Feed

- View posts shared by alumni and students
- Like or unlike posts
- Share posts
- Interact with other users

Connections

- Search users by:
  - Name
  - Department
  - Company
- Send connection requests
- Remove connections
- Build professional network

Jobs & Internships

- Browse available opportunities
- Filter jobs by category (internship, full-time, etc.)
- View job details
- Save or apply for jobs
- Share job postings

Messaging System

- Real-time chat with connections
- View conversation list
- Send and receive messages instantly

- Search chats

Achievement Posting

- Upload achievements with image
- Add description
- Share with network
- View your posted achievements

User Profile

- Edit personal details:
  - Name
  - Department
  - Graduation year
  - Skills
  - Company
- Update profile picture
- View your connections and activity
- Access saved jobs and posts

Important Notes

- Alumni accounts require approval before login
- All interactions (posts, messages, jobs) are user-specific
- Profile information should be kept updated for better networking
- Users can log out anytime from profile settings

Troubleshooting

Login Issues

- Check email and password
- Ensure alumni account is approved

App Not Working Properly

- Restart the application
- Check internet connection

Unable to See Data

- Refresh the app
- Log out and log in again

Summary

Alumnyx provides a simple and effective platform for students and alumni to connect, communicate, and grow professionally. It combines networking, job opportunities, and communication into a single system for better engagement.

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